

landline you'll never use? You have to make that call to see if it might be worth the additional rate.

For example, through one company in our area, you can get high-speed internet (20 Mbps) at a promotional rate for just \$34.95. TV costs another \$34.99, making that a total of \$69.94 for both. But if you buy a bundle package, you can score both services for just \$59.94 per month, or a savings of \$10, which adds up to \$120 per year. Granted, the internet bumps down to 10 Mbps with the package, but that's not a deal breaker when you can save that much!

Also, be aware of the 24-month commitment. Satellite companies in particular like to offer you a great rate for the first twelve months of a two-year commitment. If you sign one of these, know that your bill will probably skyrocket for months 13-24.

3. NEGOTIATE WITH YOUR PROVIDER

Similar to cable, a phone call to your internet company is a great way to haggle a lower cost. See if you can jump on any new customer promotions for a set time period and use a competitor's price as leverage to force their hand.

We did this when we faced a painful price hike after two years of loyal service to one company. Our bill jumped from \$45 to \$70/month—a considerable increase.

We called and explained that we really wanted to stay with them, but company X had a very enticing promotional rate of \$39.95, and we were thinking of switching. Our original company bumped us down to \$31 per month, which was \$14 less than we were paying before. Now I only wish we had called them sooner!

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